



NEWFOUNDLAND AND LABRADOR TRAPPERS ASSOCIATION



PO Box 16
Bishop's Falls NL A0H 1C0



nltapresident2026@hotmail.com

Newfoundland & Labrador Trappers Association (NLTA)

Minutes of Meeting 49

Date: April 11, 2026

Time: 9:00 AM – 2:47 PM

Location: Mt Peyton, Grand Falls-Windsor, NL

Chair: Shawn Reid (until 9:20 AM), then Steve Chippett

Attendees:

Jeff Butler, Blair Butler, Steve Chippett, Johnny Smith, Clay Grant, Cliff Bull, Francis Ogden, Jason White, Seally Coats, Matt Learie, Michael Warford, Shawn Smith, Doug Butt, Hearder Muggridge, Jim Fry, Megan Budgell, David Woodworth, Ian Ereaud, Evan Wells, Perry Warren, Todd Green, Blake Russell, Rex Holloway, Janice Holloway, Wayne Penny, Hank Clarke, Kevin Gillard, Neil Jeddore

1. Opening

Shawn Reid called the meeting to order at 9:00 AM.

Agenda Item 1: Election of Executive Officers

- **President:** Steve Chippett
 - Moved by Johnny Smith; seconded by Perry Warren.
 - Motion carried (Resolution **49-1**).
- **Vice President:** Perry Warren
 - Moved by Todd Green; seconded by Blake Russell.
 - Motion carried (Resolution **49-2**).
- **Secretary:** David Woodworth
 - Moved by Jim Fry; seconded by Shawn Reid.

- o Motion carried (Resolution **49-3**).

At 9:20 AM, President-elect Steve Chippett assumed the chair, with the newly elected Vice President, Secretary, and former Treasurer seated at the table.

2. Presentation – NL Wildlife Division

Bruce Rodrigues, NL Wildlife Division, addressed the meeting regarding trapping and fur management in Newfoundland and Labrador.

- Bruce introduced his supervisor, Donny Keats has 32 years of experience with WD.
- He requested resolutions to support the Division's Game Plan meeting in November.

Topics Discussed:

- Brake-away snares for lynx should not be required since 1/16 cable has a lower breaking strength than the break-away.
- Beaver and lynx tagging/stamping. Bring back old tagging system.
- Assignment of beaver traplines on Newfoundland Island. Helpers should be permitted and the new permit system stopped or more detail required when and where beaver were trapped.
- Beaver should not be trapped (live trapping excluded) by WD Officials. If beaver are removed by wildlife, they should be put back on same line.
- Beaver line holders should be made public on maps much same as Crown Landowners. Privacy protection is not an issue. This will allow accidental catch's to be returned to line owner.
- Season dates for water species except otter and mink (East Nov 1/West Oct 20). Otter and Mink be 2 weeks later in both zones.
- Lynx season dates be extended by minimum two weeks on the end of current season both zones.
- Mandatory beaver returns to be submitted by June 30. If not done no licence issued the next year. However, the return process should be more user friendly online.
- Mink and weasel season closing dates extend to March 15
- Trap and stealing signage. Discussion was had around if we put signage up our traps/fur would be stolen. More discussion to be had at next AGM.
- Rabbit wire 3-year plan. The martens are back. Where are we on the rabbit wire plan.
- Marten accidental catch management. There needs to be a plan put in place for sale of accidental marten catches with approval from WD.
- Island be divided into two zones. East and West. Line dividing the two zones being Bay D'Espoir Hwy. West open Oct 20th and East open Nov 1st. Mink and Otter open two weeks later in each zone.
- Bear licence to be separate from a trapper's licence. Training required to trap bear is completely different from trapping other furs. The bear trapping portion of the course should be a stand-alone compressed course.

- Shooting season for coyote be same as opening day for trapping. Shooting of Fox/Lynx prohibited
 - Beaver line holders to have helpers introduced on the lines. New beaver permits to be stopped.
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3. Lunch Break

Meeting recessed for lunch at 12:00 noon.

4. Afternoon Session (1:00 PM)

4.1 NLTA Webpage

- Plan to develop NLTA webpage and member email list for dues collection (~70 paid members).

4.2 Next Annual General Meeting (AGM)

- Resolution: Next AGM scheduled for April 10, 2027, at Deer Lake, NL.

4.3 Trapper Education & Licenses

- Bear license to require trapper education for bear only. Not a full trapper's course. Should be two different courses and practical training.
- We have 3000 trained trappers in NL. Training should be stopped until we an assessment can be done.
- Request to reduce fees for trapper cabins and increase allowable size on Crown land.

4.4 Fees & Payments

- Payment of FIC 2026 fee: \$250.00
- Payment for trappers' service to remove nuisance beaver (\$100–\$300)

4.5 Coyote Season

- Resolution: Coyote shooting season to coincide with trapping season.

5. Financial Report

- Presented by Shawn Reid:

- o Current balance: [REDACTED]
- o Expected revenue: [REDACTED]
- o Insured amount: [REDACTED]

6. Draw for Prizes

Prizes were drawn for attendees.

7. Election of Directors

Position	Name
President	Steve Chippett
Vice President	Perry Warren
Secretary	David Woodworth
Treasurer	Shawn Reid
Western Director	Evan Wells
Eastern Director	Matt Learie
Labrador Director	David Woodworth
Central Directors	Blake Russell / Doug Butt
Southern Director	Kris Shave
At Large Directors	Todd Green / Megan Budgell

8. Adjournment

9. Resolution Summary Table

Resolution No.	Description	Moved By	Seconded By	Outcome
49-1	Election of Steve Chippett as President	Johnny Smith	Perry Warren	Carried
49-2	Election of Perry Warren as Vice President	Todd Green	Blake Russell	Carried
49-3	Election of David Woodworth as Secretary	Jim Fry	Shawn Reid	Carried
49-4	No requirement for brake-away snares for lynx	Blake Russell	Megan Budgell	Carried
49-5	Mandatory returns by trappers to support fur management	Todd Green	Matt Learie	Carried
49-6	Implementation of tagging/stamping for beaver and lynx	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-7	Assignment of beaver traplines on Newfoundland Island	Todd Green	Matt Learie	Carried
49-8	Season dates for water species except Beaver be 2 weeks later – East Nov 1 & West Oct 20 with Bay D’Espoir Hwy boundary line.	Todd Green	Matt Learie	Carried
49-9	Lynx season dates – Newfoundland Island extended minimum 2 weeks on end of current season.	Kevin Gillard	Matt Learie	Carried
49-10	Mandatory returns submitted by June 30 before license issuance	Header Muggridge	Michael Warford	Carried
49-11	Change closing dates for mink and weasel to March 15	Hank Clarke	Neil Jeddore	Carried
49-12	Implementation of trap and stealing signage	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-13	Continue 3-year rabbit wire plan with feedback	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-14	Management of accidental marten catches	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-15	Plan to develop NLTA webpage and member email list	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-16	Next AGM scheduled for April 10, 2027, at Deer Lake, NL	Header Muggridge	Megan Budgell	Carried
49-17	Bear license to require separate trapper education course and practical training	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-18	Request to reduce fees for trapper cabins on Crown land	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-19	Payment of FIC 2026 fee (\$250.00)	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-20	Payment for trappers’ service to remove nuisance beaver (\$100–\$300)	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried
49-21	Coyote shooting season to coincide with trapping season	Perry Warren	Michael Warford	Carried

Resolution No.	Description	Moved By	Seconded By	Outcome
49-22	Financial report noting \$40,000 balance and \$13,000 insured	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Noted
49-23	Shooting of Fox/Lynx to be prohibited	Megan Budgell	Blake Russell	Carried
49-24	Beaver line holders to have helpers on the line. New beaver permits to be stopped.	Perry Warren	Steve Chippett	Carried
49-25	Adjournment of meeting at 2:47 PM	[Discussion]	[Discussion]	Carried

Minutes prepared by:

Date of preparation:
